

To Whom It May Concern,

It is my sincere pleasure to recommend Yafei Zhang, who served as a Merchandising Intern on my team at PlanetArt during the summer of 2026. Over the course of the internship, Yafei took on a remarkably broad scope of work and consistently delivered at a level well beyond what I typically expect from an intern.

Yafei's contributions spanned the full breadth of the merchandising function.

She supported website updates, assisted with product pricing, product assortment planning, and managed all projects with impressive accuracy and attention to detail. Yafei also conducted competitive analysis and researched promotional opportunities, synthesizing findings into clear, actionable recommendations that informed our team's strategic decisions.

Along the way, Yafei became proficient with the tools of the trade, from Excel and our internal admin systems to pricing and promotional templates, ramping up quickly and requiring minimal oversight.

What sets Yafei apart is a rare combination of analytical rigor and creativity. On the analytical side, she excelled at researching and organizing complex datasets, bringing structure and clarity to large volumes of information and making it far easier for our team to identify trends and act on insights.

On the creative side, Yafei demonstrated a strong eye for visual merchandising and even built website prototypes for future development, going beyond day-to-day execution to help shape what comes next.

Perhaps most impressive was Yafei's problem-solving ability and solution-oriented mindset. When faced with a challenge, she never simply flagged it, Yafei came to the table with well-thought-out options and a recommendation.

This mindset was best exemplified by her initiative in leveraging AI to build tools that streamline our team's processes. Rather than accepting inefficiencies as the status quo, Yafei identified pain points and built practical solutions - a level of forward-thinking and technical curiosity that led to our team mapping concepts for future tools that will be built for the department.

Yafei paired all of this with excellent communication skills, presenting findings clearly, asking thoughtful questions, and keeping stakeholders informed. Just as importantly, Yafei was a complete pleasure to work with and a wonderful cultural fit for our team - collaborative, positive, receptive to feedback, and quick to take ownership of new challenges. She adapted seamlessly to the fast pace of e-commerce merchandising, brought great energy to the office every day, and earned the trust and genuine fondness of colleagues across the team.

I give Yafei my highest recommendation and am confident she will be a tremendous asset to any organization fortunate enough to have her. Please feel free to contact me at (562) 252-2261 or sophias@planetart.com if you have any questions.

Sincerely,

Sophia Sunjara
Director, Merchandising
PlanetArt